

End-to-End Operational Workflow

The Exact Sequence, Step by Step, From Signature to Renewal or Exit

Purpose

Every other Tier 4 document explains the design. This one is the workflow: the exact sequence of steps, triggers, owners, tools, and SLAs, in order, so nothing depends on memory or improvisation.

Assumptions

Thresholds, SLAs, tier values, and trigger windows throughout this document are illustrative and should be validated against customer behavior, contract structure, team capacity, and historical retention data. This is an operating model, not a fixed answer — the structure is intentional, but the specific numbers are a starting point for calibration, not a claim about any particular company's data.

Tool Stack

Tool names below are illustrative. The same workflow runs on whatever CRM, CS, support, product analytics, and billing systems a company already has.

- **Salesforce** — contract/ARR source of truth, renewal and opportunity objects
- **CS platform (Catalyst/Planhat)** — the workflow engine: health scoring, trigger rules, the pod owner's task queue, real-time dashboard
- **Zendesk/Intercom + chatbot** — support tickets and first-line triage, feeds the health score
- **Product analytics (Amplitude/Pendo)** — activation events and usage data, also feeds the health score
- **Billing (Stripe/Chargebee)** — auto-renew execution and payment status
- **Survey tool (Typeform/Delighted)** — the 2-question exit survey
- **BI/reporting layer (Looker or a shared dashboard)** — where the quarterly segment report lives

Stage 0: Pre-Signature

Step 1. Sales logs account data (industry, use case, seat count) at deal creation. *Tool: Salesforce.*

Stage 1: Signature → Automated Onboarding

Step 2. ✂ Contract signed. Welcome sequence triggers same day. *Tool: Salesforce → Catalyst/Planhat.* **Step 3.** ✂ Day 0-2: welcome email, login credentials, golden-path setup checklist sent. *Tool: Customer.io / in-app (Pendo).* **Step 4.** ✂ Setup-stall nudges at day 3 and day 7. Still incomplete at day 14: flagged for manual outreach, the first human touch. *Tool: Catalyst/Planhat task queue.* **Step 5.** ✂ Cohort onboarding webinar invite sent day 1, recurring weekly or biweekly. *Tool: Zoom + Customer.io.* **Step 6.** Account attends the live session or watches the recording. *Tool: Zoom.* **Step 7.** ✂ Activation event fires on the defined first-value action. Logged as Activated. *Tool: Product analytics (Amplitude/Pendo).*

Stage 2: Steady-State Monitoring

Step 8. ✂ Health score recalculates continuously from logins, feature adoption, tickets, and payment status. *Tool: Catalyst/Planhat, pulling from Salesforce, Zendesk, and Amplitude.* **Step 9.** Pod owner reviews the dashboard on a fixed cadence, 2 to 3 times a week. *Tool: Catalyst/Planhat dashboard.* **Step 10.** Support and the chatbot handle day-to-day tickets; docs and in-app cover the rest. *Tool: Zendesk / Intercom.*

Stage 3: Risk Trigger Response

Step 11. ✂ A risk trigger fires: usage drop, no login 30+ days, a ticket spike, or the renewal window opens. Auto-generates a task with an SLA clock. *Tool: Catalyst/Planhat rule engine.* **Step 12.** Pod owner reviews the task inside the SLA window: 3 business days for usage drop, same day for severity tickets. *Tool: Catalyst/Planhat task queue.* **Step 13.** Pod owner takes action: automated nudge, direct outreach, or escalation. *Tool: Catalyst/Planhat + email.* **Step 14.** Action and outcome logged back into the system, feeding the quarterly report. *Tool: Catalyst/Planhat.*

Stage 4: Growth Trigger Response

Step 15. ✂ A growth signal fires: usage approaching contracted limits, additional properties/locations added, or repeated use by a previously inactive stakeholder group. A single new login alone triggers observation and qualification only, not an automatic growth assumption. *Tool: Catalyst/Planhat + Amplitude.* **Step 16.** ✂ In-plan signal (seat, tier bump): automated in-app upsell prompt, no human needed. *Tool: In-app (Pendo).* **Step 17.** Contract-touching signal: pod owner flags and qualifies it, hands to Sales with full context. *Tool: Catalyst/Planhat → Salesforce.*

Stage 5: Renewal Branch

Step 18. ✂ 90 days out (or the quarterly checkpoint if evergreen): reminder sequence begins, health score checked. *Tool: Salesforce + Catalyst/Planhat.* **Step 19.** ✂ Healthy, auto-renew-eligible account: automated renewal path continues, with confirmation and exception monitoring. No bespoke save motion required. *Tool: Billing (Stripe/Chargebee).* **Step 20.** Degraded account: routed to the pod owner for a manual save, before the renewal date. *Tool: Catalyst/Planhat task queue.* **Step 21.** Pod owner runs the save: direct re-engagement, no contract terms involved. *Tool: Email / Catalyst-Planhat.* **Step 22.** Contract concession genuinely needed: routed to Sales. Pod owner does not negotiate pricing. *Tool: Salesforce.*

Stage 6: Cross-Cutting Escalation Rule

Step 23. Escalation is tiered by severity, not a flat count: one severe trigger prompts immediate review, two moderate triggers prompt manual review, and repeated low-severity triggers prompt a pattern review, all inside a rolling 60-day window, regardless of the account's current health score. This rule overrides everything else in this document. *Tool: Catalyst/Planhat rule engine. Owner: CS Leadership.*

Stage 7: Cancellation, If It Happens

Step 24. ✂ Non-renewal confirmed. A 2-question exit survey sends automatically. *Tool: Typeform / Delighted.* **Step 25.** ✂ The account's full ARR logs to the churn line, not contraction. *Tool: Salesforce → Finance/BI reporting.* **Step 26.** Offboarding: access removal and data handling per contract terms. *Tool: IT/Access management + Zendesk.* **Step 27.** ✂ Exit survey data rolls into the next quarterly segment report. *Tool: BI dashboard (Looker).*

Stage 8: Quarterly Reporting Loop

Step 28. Pod owner compiles the segment report: activation rate, churn rate, cost-to-serve, trigger SLA compliance, cohort attendance, KB deflection rate, cohort comparison, top three churn causes, trigger-to-recovery conversion rate, percentage of flagged accounts stabilized, expansion signals sourced, accounts promoted or demoted between tiers, and automation failure/exception rate. *Tool: Catalyst/Planhat → BI dashboard (Looker).* **Step 29.** Findings feed back into the system: knowledge base gaps go to docs, recurring product issues go to Product, and the report becomes the briefing document for the next quarter's incoming pod owner. *Tool: Docs CMS + Productboard.*

Where Reporting Lives

Real-time health scores and trigger activity live in the Catalyst/Planhat dashboard, the pod owner's day-to-day view. The quarterly segment report is a rollup, pulled from that same platform into a BI dashboard (Looker) or a shared deck, which is what CS Leadership actually reviews. Two views, one underlying dataset.

What This Workflow Protects Against

- **A customer falling through the cracks silently.** Every stage either has an automated check or a human review point. Nothing just sits.
- **A bad quarter compounding unnoticed.** The quarterly reporting loop exists specifically so a slow bleed gets caught before it's a mass exit, the real risk at this tier's volume.
- **Retention work turning into unpaid sales work.** The line between the pod owner's job and Sales's job is drawn at exactly one place: does it touch a contract.

Artifacts Referenced in This Workflow

- Automated welcome sequence (Stage 1)
- Golden-path setup checklist (Stage 1)
- Health scoring formula (Stage 2, detailed in Playbook 6)
- Trigger rule set with SLA windows (Stage 3, detailed in Playbook 6)
- 90-day renewal branch logic (Stage 5, detailed in Playbook 6)
- 2-question exit survey (Stage 7)
- Quarterly segment report template (Stage 8, detailed in Playbook 7)